

Group

Groups

- Two or more individuals, interacting and interdependent, who come together to achieve particular objectives
- Formal – defined by the organization's structure
- Informal – neither formally structured nor organizationally determined



Group...Cont'd

Four Types of Groups

- Command – determined by the organization chart
- Task – working together to complete a job task
- Interest – affiliate to attain a specific objective of shared interest
- Friendship – members have one or more common characteristics

Group...Cont'd

Why People Join Groups

Security. By joining a group, individuals can reduce the insecurity of having to stand on their own. People feel stronger, have fewer self-doubts, and are more resistant to threats when they are part of a group.

Status. Inclusion in a group that is viewed as important by others provides recognition and status for its members.

Self-esteem. Groups can provide people with feelings of self-worth. That is, in addition to conveying status to those outside the group, membership can also give increased feelings of worth to the group members themselves.

Affiliation. Groups can fulfill social needs. People enjoy the regular interaction that comes with group membership. For many people, these on-the-job interactions are their primary source for fulfilling their needs for affiliation.

Power. What cannot be achieved individually often becomes possible through group action. There is power in numbers.

Goal Achievement. Sometimes it takes more than one person to accomplish a particular task, so people pool talents, knowledge, or power. In such instances, management will rely on the use of a formal group.

Group...Cont'd

Group Properties

- Roles
- Norms
- Status
- Size
- Cohesiveness



Group...Cont'd

Roles

- Role Expectations – how others believe you should act in a given situation
- Psychological contract – an unwritten agreement between employees and employer setting out mutual expectations
- Role conflict – when an individual finds that compliance with one role requirement may make it more difficult to comply with another

Group...Cont'd

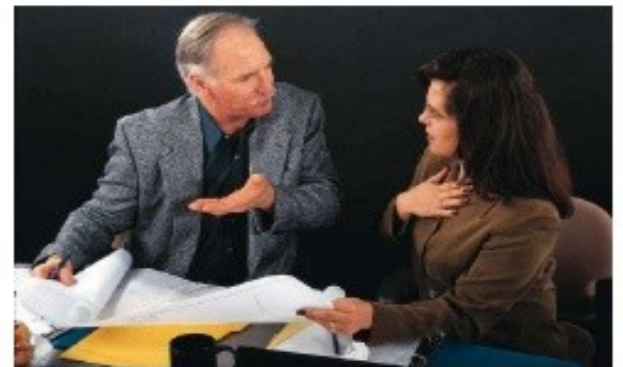
Roles

- To engage in a set of expected behavior patterns that are attributed to occupying a given position in a social unit
- Role Identity – attitudes and behaviors consistent with a role
- Role Perception – our view of how we're supposed to act in a given situation

Group...Cont'd

Norms

- Acceptable standards of behavior within a group that are shared by the group's members
- Tell members of a group what they ought and ought not to do under certain circumstances



Group...Cont'd

The Hawthorne Studies

- A worker's behavior and sentiments were closely related.
- Group influences were significant in affecting individual behavior.
- Group standards were highly effective in establishing individual worker output.
- Money was less a factor in determining worker output than were group standards, sentiments, and security.

Group...Cont'd

Conformity and the Asch Studies

- Members desire to be one of the group and avoid being visibly different
- Members with differing opinions feel extensive pressure to align with others
- Level of conformity has declined since 1950's



Group...Cont'd

Deviant Workplace Behavior

- Voluntary behavior that violates significant organizational norms and, in doing so, threatens the well-being of the organization or its members
- Is likely to flourish where it is supported by group norms

Group...Cont'd

Status

- A socially defined position or rank given to groups or group members by others



Group...Cont'd

What Determines Status?

- The power a person wields over others
- A person's ability to contribute to a group's goals
- An individual's personal characteristics

Group...Cont'd

Impact of Status

- High-status members of groups often are given more freedom to deviate from norms
- Interaction among members of groups is influenced by status
- When inequity is perceived, it results in various types of corrective behavior
- Cultural differences affect status

Group...Cont'd

How Size Affects a Group

- Smaller groups are faster at completing tasks
- Individuals perform better in smaller groups
- Large groups are consistently better at problem solving
- Social loafing - tendency to expend less effort in a group than as an individual

Group...Cont'd

Cohesiveness

- The degree to which members of the group are attracted to each other and motivated to stay in the group
- Related to the group's productivity



Group...Cont'd

Relationship of Cohesiveness to Productivity

		Cohesiveness	
		High	Low
Performance norms	High	High productivity	Moderate productivity
	Low	Low productivity	Moderate to low productivity

Group...Cont'd

How Can Managers Encourage Cohesiveness?

1. Make the group smaller
2. Encourage agreement with group goals
3. Increase the time spent together
4. Increase the status and perceived difficulty of group membership
5. Stimulate competition with other groups
6. Give rewards to the group rather than to individual members
7. Physically isolate the group

Group...Cont'd

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Group...Cont'd

Symptoms of Groupthink

- Group members rationalize any resistance to their assumptions
- Members pressure any doubters to support the alternative favored by the majority
- Doubters keep silent about misgivings and minimize their importance
- Group interprets members' silence as a "yes" vote for the majority

Group...Cont'd

Groupthink occurs most often when

- A clear group identity exists
- Members hold a positive image of their group that they want to protect
- The group perceives a collective threat to this positive image



Group...Cont'd

Minimizing Groupthink

- Limit group size to 10 or less
- Encourage group leaders to actively seek input from all members and avoid expressing their own opinions, especially in the early stages of deliberation
- Appoint a “devil’s advocate”

Group...Cont'd

Groupshift

- Decision of the group reflects the dominant decision-making norm that develops during the group's discussion
- Exaggerates the initial position of the members and more often to greater risk



Group...Cont'd

Group Decision-Making Techniques

- Reduce common problems with:
 - Brainstorming – technique to encourage any and all alternatives while withholding any criticism of the alternatives
 - Nominal group technique – restricts discussion during the process to encourage independent thinking
 - Electronic meetings – use computers to anonymously give honest input

Group...Cont'd

Satisfaction Implication for Managers

- High congruence between boss and employee on perception of job shows significant association with employee satisfaction
- Satisfaction is greater when job minimizes interaction with individuals of lower status
- Larger groups are associated with lower satisfaction

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Summary

1. Differentiated between formal and informal groups
2. Described how role requirements change in different situations
3. Described how norms exert influence on an individual's behavior
4. Explained what determines status
5. Defined social loafing and its effect on group performance
6. Identified the benefits and disadvantages of cohesive groups
7. Listed the strengths and weaknesses of group decision making
8. Contrasted the effectiveness of interacting, brainstorming, nominal and electronic meeting groups

Understanding Work teams

Why Have Teams Become So Popular

- Teams typically outperform individuals.
- Teams use employee talents better.
- Teams are more flexible and responsive to changes in the environment.
- Teams facilitate employee involvement.
- Teams are an effective way to democratize and organization and increase motivation.

Team vs Group

Team Versus Group: What's the Difference

Work Group

A group that interacts primarily to share information and to make decisions to help each group member perform within his or her area of responsibility.

Work Team

A group whose individual efforts result in a performance that is greater than the sum of the individual inputs.



Team vs Group...Cont'd

Comparing Work Groups and Work Teams

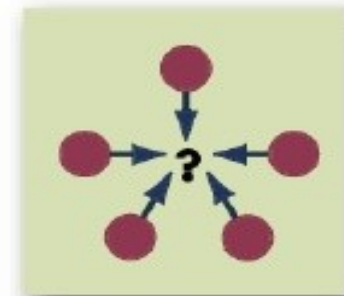


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Types of Teams

Problem-Solving Teams

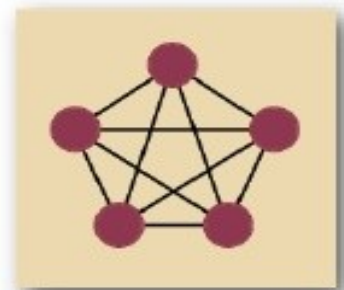
Groups of 5 to 12 employees from the same department who meet for a few hours each week to discuss ways of improving quality, efficiency, and the work environment.



Problem-solving

Self-Managed Work Teams

Groups of 10 to 15 people who take on the responsibilities of their former supervisors.



Self-managed

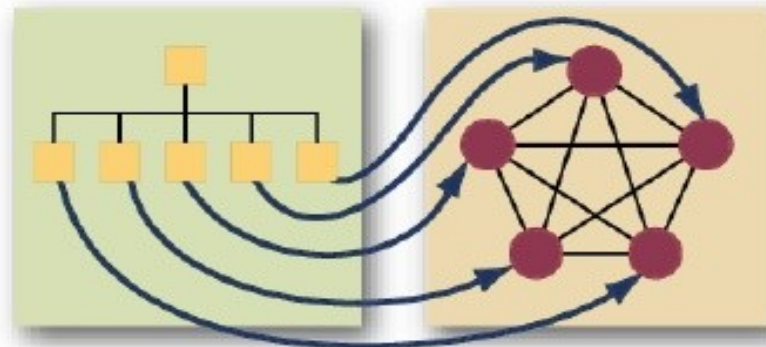
Teams...Cont'd

Types of Teams (cont'd)

Cross-Functional Teams

Employees from about the same hierarchical level, but from different work areas, who come together to accomplish a task.

- Task forces
- Committees



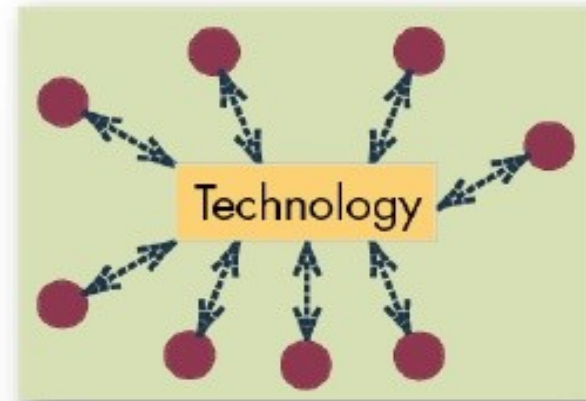
Cross-functional

Teams...Cont'd

Types of Teams (cont'd)

Virtual Teams

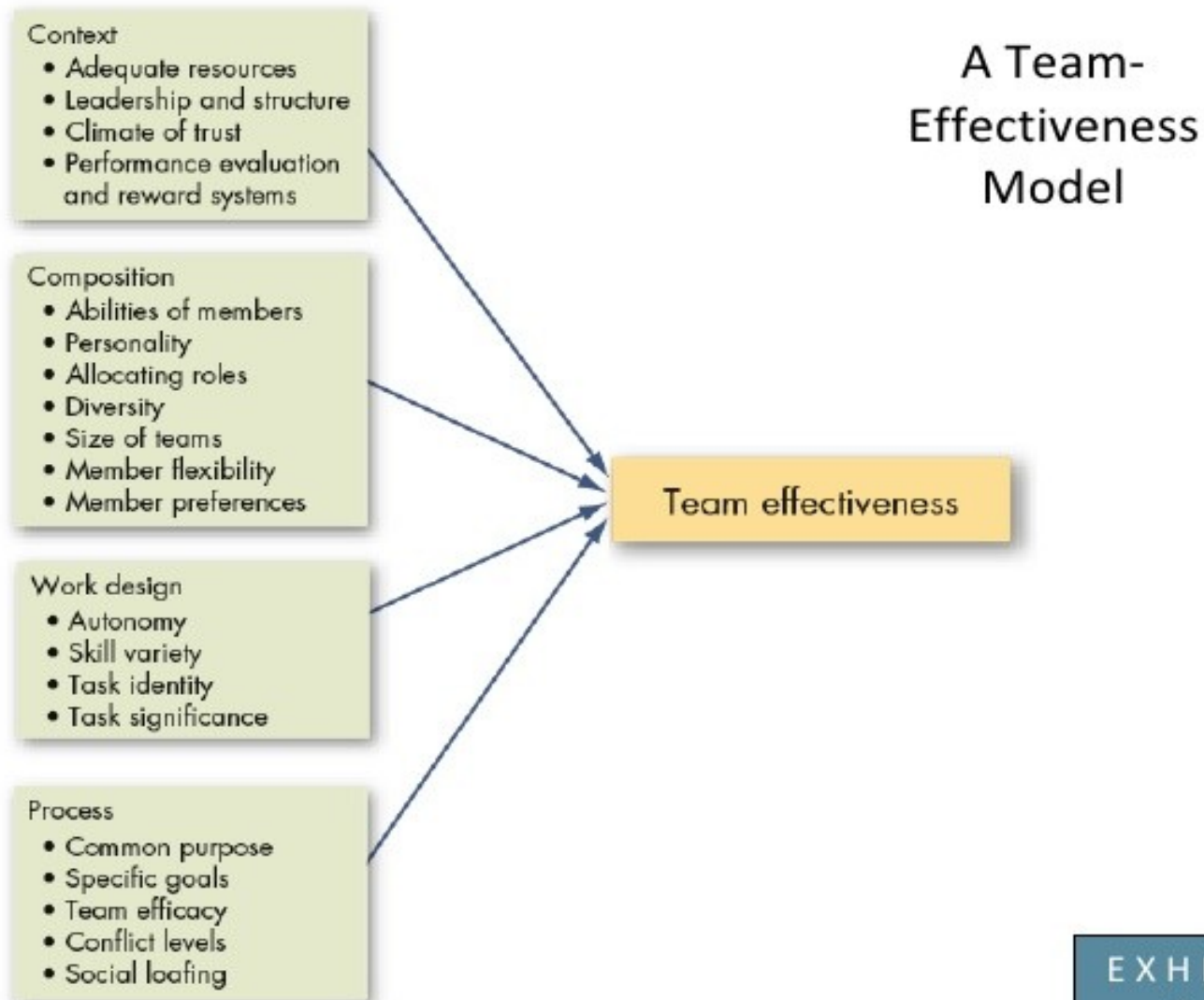
Teams that use computer technology to tie together physically dispersed members in order to achieve a common goal.



Virtual

Team Characteristics

Teams...Cont'd



Teams...Cont'd

Creating Effective Teams

Context

- Adequate resources
- Leadership
- Climate of trust
- Performance evaluation and rewards

Teams...Cont'd

Creating Effective Teams (cont'd)

Composition

- Ability
- Personality
- Roles and diversity
- Size
- Flexibility
- Preference for teamwork

Teams...Cont'd

Key Roles of Teams

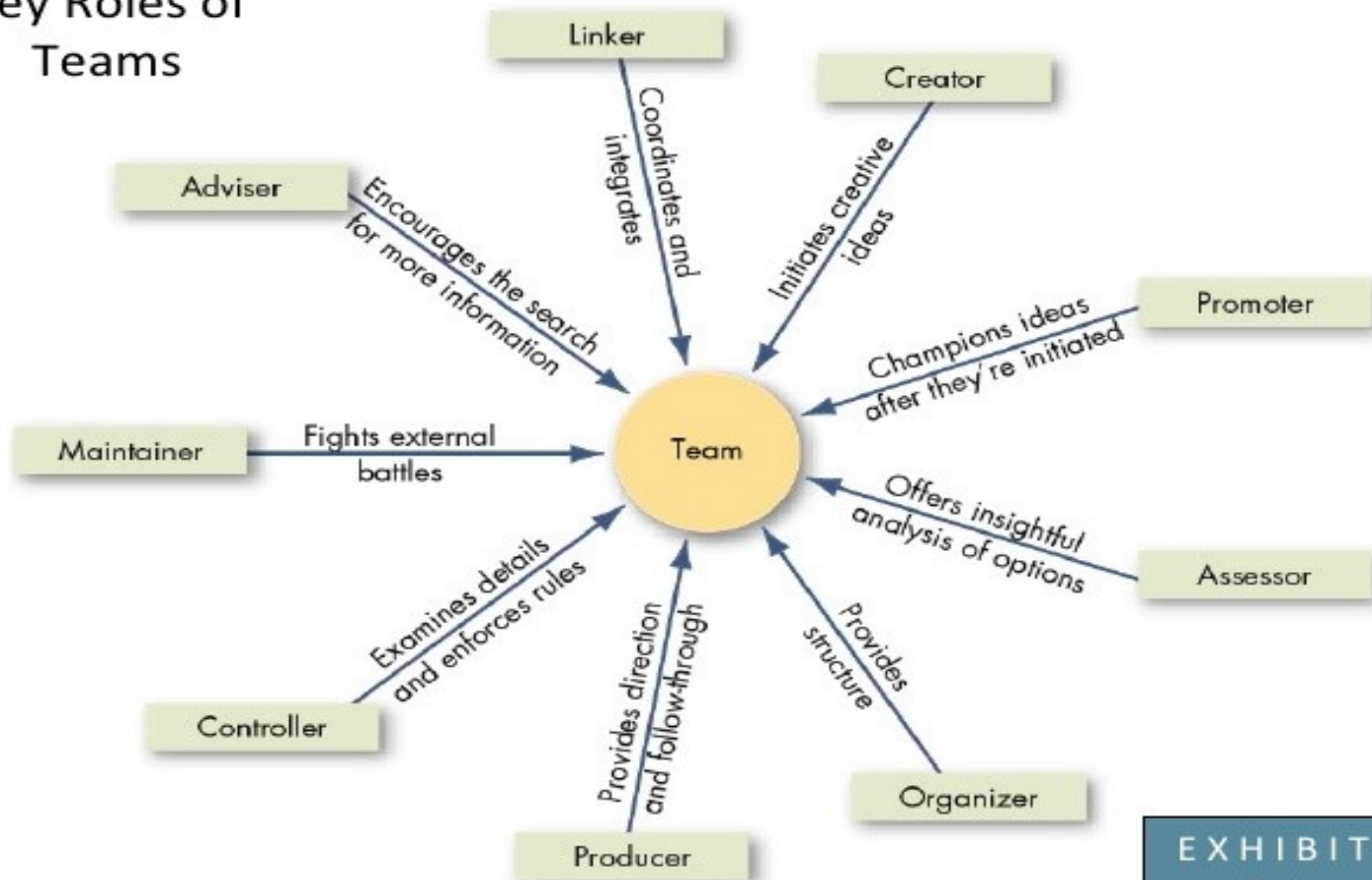


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Teams...Cont'd

Creating Effective Teams (cont'd)

Work design

- Autonomy
- Skill variety
- Task identity
- Task significance

Teams...Cont'd

Creating Effective Teams (cont'd)

Process

- Common purpose
- Specific goals
- Team efficacy
- Conflict
- Social loafing

Teams...Cont'd

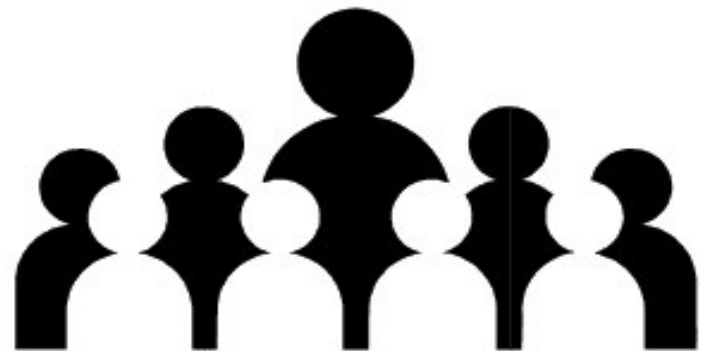
Creating Effective Teams: Diversity

Group Demography

The degree to which members of a group share a common demographic attribute, such as age, sex, race, educational level, or length of service in the organization, and the impact of this attribute on turnover.

Cohorts

Individuals who, as part of a group, hold a common attribute.



Teams...Cont'd

Turning Individuals Into Team Players

- The Challenges
 - Overcoming individual resistance to team membership.
 - Countering the influence of individualistic cultures.
 - Introducing teams in an organization that has historically valued individual achievement.
- Shaping Team Players
 - Selecting employees who can fulfill their team

Teams...Cont'd

Teams and Quality Management

- Team Effectiveness and Quality Management Requires That Teams:
 1. Are small enough to be efficient and effective.
 2. Are properly trained in required skills.
 3. Allocated enough time to work on problems.
 4. Are given authority to resolve problems and take corrective action.
 5. Have a designated “champion” to call on when needed.

Summary

Beware: Teams are not always the answer!

There are three test to see if a team fits the situation. They are:

1. Is the work complex that needs different perspectives?
2. Does the work create a common purpose or set of goals for the group that is larger than the aggregate of the goals for individuals?
3. Are members of the group within interdependent tasks?

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